

# HOUSE . . . . . No. 506

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## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

***Shirley B. Arriaga***

*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to youth and athletics.

PETITION OF:

| NAME:                     | DISTRICT/ADDRESS:    | DATE ADDED:      |
|---------------------------|----------------------|------------------|
| <i>Shirley B. Arriaga</i> | <i>8th Hampden</i>   | <i>1/10/2025</i> |
| <i>Orlando Ramos</i>      | <i>9th Hampden</i>   | <i>4/9/2025</i>  |
| <i>Priscila S. Sousa</i>  | <i>6th Middlesex</i> | <i>5/8/2025</i>  |

# HOUSE . . . . . No. 506

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By Representative Arriaga of Chicopee, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 506) of Shirley B. Arriaga relative to youth and athletics and establishing the PLAY trust fund to be administered by the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education. Education.

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## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

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In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court  
(2025-2026)  
\_\_\_\_\_

An Act relative to youth and athletics.

*Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:*

1 Chapter 29 of the General Laws is hereby amended by inserting after section 2JJJJJ,  
2 added by section 7 of chapter 248 of chapter 2024, the following section:-

3 Section 2KKKKKK. (a) There shall be established and set upon the books of the  
4 commonwealth a separate fund to be known as the PLAY Trust Fund. The commissioner of the  
5 department of elementary and secondary education shall administer the fund. The fund shall be  
6 used for: (i) funding youth athletics for K-8 public school students in districts across the  
7 commonwealth; (ii) supporting K-8 public school students and their families by paying fees  
8 related to sports that they are unable to afford to pay; and (iii) combating childhood obesity by  
9 promoting and allowing children to play youth sports.

10 (b) The fund shall be credited with: (i) revenue from appropriations and other money  
11 authorized by the general court and specifically designated to be credited to the fund; (ii) funds  
12 from public and private sources such as gifts, grants and donations; (iii) 1 per cent of the total

funds collected from the excised tax imposed upon sports wagering operators in the commonwealth pursuant to section 14 of chapter 23N; and (iv) interest earned on money in the fund. Amounts credited to the fund shall not be subject to further appropriation and any money remaining in the fund at the end of a fiscal year shall not revert to the General Fund.

(c) Annually, not later than October 1, the commissioner of elementary and secondary education shall report to the clerks of the senate and house of representatives, the joint committee on education and the house and senate committees on ways and means on the fund's activities. The report shall include, but not be limited to: (i) the source and amount of funds received; (ii) the expenditures made from the fund and the purposes of such expenditures; (iii) any anticipated remaining revenue from awards; (vi) the number of students and families who received funding; and (v) the report shall be publicly available on the department's website.